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THE WHITE HOUSE
WASHINGTON

July 22, 1995

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INFORMATION

MEMORANDUM FOR THE PRESIDENT

FROM: ANTHONY LAKE 

SUBJECT: Your Meeting with Christopher and Shalikashvili on the London Meeting on Bosnia. (Perry cannot attend; John White will attend.)

Military Results of London: We got essentially what we wanted in London on Gorazde, taking into account the limits on consensus created by the composition of the meeting (see press points, attached). The military paper agreed by the U.S., UK and France is a tremendous advance over previous NATO air strike decisions in terms of broader targeting and modification of the dual key:

- authority to initiate the air campaign would be in the hands of the NATO air commander, Admiral Smith, and the UNPROFOR force commander on the ground, General Smith. This is consistent with normal military practice;
- in addition, once the air campaign is initiated, the NATO commander would have sole authority to continue the air strikes until the Serbs halt their attacks on Gorazde. The UN commander couldn't turn off his key.

Follow-up: The plan will be taken up by NATO's Military Committee over the weekend. The NAC meets today to endorse the London results and provide the necessary taskings to the NATO Military Authorities, with a view to NAC approval on Monday. In parallel, we, the Brits and French will weigh in with Boutros-Ghali to delegate his key.

We suggest you ask Shali:

- whether he sees any limitations on targeting;
- whether we can count on General Smith to turn his key; and
- whether NATO needs to deploy any additional air assets to implement the plan.

You should also ask Chris:

- whether Boutros-Ghali will give up his key; and

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cc: Vice President
Chief of Staff

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- **how to manage the Russians.**

Warning to the Serbs: It was agreed in London that we, the British and French would deliver a private warning to General Mladic even before the NAC has approved the plan (either tomorrow or on Monday). The British will send a senior Air Force officer as their emissary, along with an Under Secretary of Defense; the French are doing roughly the same. **We should probably designate an Air Force General as well.**

Other Safe Areas: The London warning applies only to Gorazde; the other Allies were reluctant to extend the new military plan to Sarajevo or other safe areas, but agreed this could be done later through another NAC decision if necessary. **With the escalation in Bihac and threat of Croatian intervention, you might ask whether we should move quickly to extend the warning to Bihac and, perhaps, Sarajevo as well.**

Diplomatic Track: The British made a last-minute push to have the London meeting endorse the package that Carl Bildt has worked out with Milosevic on recognition of Bosnia and border closure in return for sanctions relief. Bildt threatened to resign if the plan wasn't approved, but he was calmed (at least temporarily) by being given an audience with Contact Group Foreign Ministers last night. We refused to endorse the Bildt package because:

- the Bosnian Government has problems with the package (and we have always refused to impose terms on the Bosnians);
- we still have problems with the mechanism for reimposing sanctions and the overly generous amount of sanctions relief provided up front; and
- it is debatable whether now is the right time to give any new rewards to Milosevic, after Srebrenica and Zepa.

You should ask Chris to:

- give his view on where we go with the Bildt package; and
- whether we should modify our position on contacts with the Bosnian Serbs in order to get direct talks going among the parties while we have a window of opportunity following the London meeting.

Attachment

Tab A Press Points on London Meeting

LONDON MEETING ON BOSNIA

- We went to London convinced that the status quo in Bosnia was untenable and that only strong and decisive action would be sufficient to halt Serb aggression, restore UNPROFOR's effectiveness, and reestablish conditions that could lead to a political settlement.
- We were particularly determined that clear decisions be taken to prevent the Bosnian Serbs from attacking the last remaining safe area in eastern Bosnia, Gorazde, and that measures be adopted for relieving the Serbs' siege of Sarajevo.
- The London meeting achieved these objectives. The key now is to move quickly to translate these decisions into reality. Let me review the decisions and their significance:
- First, there was agreement that any Bosnian Serb attack on Gorazde would be met with a "substantial and decisive response." This means a strong and decisive response by NATO air power, going beyond the limited strikes conducted previously, if the Serbs defy our warning.
 - The U.S., UK and France agreed on a concept of operations that provides for broad-gauged strikes against military forces attacking Gorazde or concentrating for an attack, against supporting forces and command-and-control and, if necessary, against military targets elsewhere in Bosnia.
 - It would also modify the "dual key" in a significant way, taking UN political authorities out of the chain of command and placing authority to initiate the air campaign in the hands of the NATO air commander, Admiral Leighton Smith, and the UNPROFOR force commander on the ground, General Rupert Smith. This is consistent with normal military practice.
 - Moreover, once the air campaign is initiated, the NATO commander would have sole authority to continue the air strikes until the Serbs halt their attacks on Gorazde.
- The NAC will meet today to task work by NATO's military authorities. The plan will then be discussed by the NATO Military Committee, with a view to a decision by the North Atlantic Council (NAC) on Monday to put the new approach into effect.
 - I should point out that existing authority for air strikes and close air support is still in effect should the Serbs move on Gorazde (or other safe areas) before the NAC has acted.
- We have agreed with the British and French that the new approach could be applied to the other safe areas if necessary. This would require only a decision by the NAC to do so.
- The second important decision in London was to take decisive action to ensure access to Sarajevo for delivery of humanitarian aid and resupply of UN forces, through early use of the Rapid Reaction Force. The British announced their decision to send a battalion to Sarajevo to further strengthen the effectiveness of UN capabilities there.

- The London meeting also reaffirmed the international community's commitment to achieving a political settlement, stressing the urgency of renewed negotiations among the Bosnian parties based on the Contact Group plan.
 - The participants voiced their support for the efforts of EU mediator Carl Bildt to secure recognition of Bosnia by Serbia-Montenegro and a sealing of Serbia's border with Bosnia.
 - Bildt briefed Contact Group Ministers on the package he has worked out with Milosevic, but that package was not approved; in fact, we see a number of issues that still need to be satisfactorily resolved, and we also need to consult with the Bosnian Government on whether the terms for mutual recognition are acceptable.
- The participants in the meeting also agreed to increase support for efforts to address Bosnia's humanitarian crisis, which was exacerbated by the Serb attacks on Srebrenica and Zepa and the new wave of brutal ethnic cleansing. The participants demanded the international community be given immediate access to all detainees still being held by the Bosnian Serbs.
- Underlying all these decisions is a reaffirmation that a strengthened and more effective UNPROFOR should remain in Bosnia.
 - We continue to believe that UNPROFOR's withdrawal would lead to a larger human tragedy in Bosnia and an increased danger of wider conflict in the Balkans.
 - Our allies made clear in London that action by the U.S. to lift the arms embargo unilaterally will force the withdrawal of UNPROFOR. It would also undermine the London meeting's renewed display of resolve for UNPROFOR to deal firmly with the Bosnian Serbs' outrageous behavior.
 - We should not be taking actions that drive UNPROFOR out at the very moment it has committed to take action to protect the Bosnian people in Gorazde and other safe areas.

Withdrawal/Redaction Sheet

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DOCUMENT NO. AND TYPE	SUBJECT/TITLE	DATE	RESTRICTION
001. cable	re. Secretary's Conversation with French FM De Charette (3 pages)	07/21/1995	P1/b(1) KSM

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Clinton Presidential Records
NSC Cables
Jan 1995-Dec 1996 ([Charette])
OA/Box Number: 510000

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